The Binding of the Agent: Items and pickups

All items and pickups in the game.

Reading the numbers

Player base stats. Item effects are added to these first, then multipliers (×) are applied:

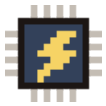
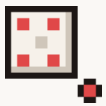
Stat	Base	Notes
Damage	3.5	per shot
Fire delay	0.38 s	time between shots, about 2.6 shots/s (shown as RATE in the HUD); lower is better
Speed	1.0	1.0 = 240 px/s
Shot speed	1.0	1.0 = 480 px/s
Range	420 px	
Shot size	1.0	1.0 = 9 px radius
Luck	0	more room-clear drops and better chances at rare pickups
Health	3 hearts	max 12 hearts in total, red and blue (guardrail) combined

Where items appear (the "Found in" column): **Treasure** room, **Shop** (for the listed price), **Boss** reward, **Secret** room. Each item appears at most once per run until every item has been seen.

Items

Stat items

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Cold Brew** `cold_brew`	Speed +0.25	Treasure, Shop, Boss	12¢	Caffeine: the original agentic framework.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Mechanical Keyboard** `mech_keyboard`	Fire delay −0.06 s	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Clack clack clack. Your open-plan office has filed a complaint.
	**Stack Overflow Printout** `stack_overflow`	Damage +1	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Marked as duplicate. Worked anyway.
	**Extended Context Window** `context_window`	Range +150, shot speed −0.1	Treasure, Boss	—	Two million tokens of things you'll forget by the next room.
	**Prompt Caching** `prompt_caching`	Fire delay ×0.75 (about +33 % fire rate)	Treasure, Shop	18¢	Same tokens, 90 % cheaper. You've basically printed money.
	**Tab Completion** `tab_completion`	Fire delay −0.08 s, range −80	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Accepts the first suggestion. Every time. Without reading.
	**Max Effort** `max_effort`	Damage +1, speed −0.1	Treasure, Boss	—	Reasoning effort: max. Everything takes longer, but hits harder.
	**Monorepo** `monorepo`	Shot size +0.6, damage +0.5, shot speed −0.2	Treasure, Boss	—	Everything in one giant blob. What could go wrong.
	**Kubernetes** `kubernetes`	A little of everything: speed +0.08, damage +0.4, fire delay −0.02 s, shot speed +0.08, range +40, shot size +0.1, luck +1	Treasure, Shop, Boss	18¢	Nobody knows what it does. Everyone agrees you need it.
	**Blockchain** `blockchain`	Nothing at all (on purpose)	Shop, Secret	20¢	Disruptive. Decentralised. Does absolutely nothing. Market cap: $4B.
	**Technical Debt** `technical_debt`	Damage ×1.6, but you lose one heart container (never below 1 heart)	Treasure, Secret	—	Ship now, pay later. With interest. Compounding.
	**Off-by-One Error** `off_by_one`	Damage +0, +1 or +2, rolled once when picked up	Treasure, Secret	—	We counted from zero. Or did we.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**YAML Config** `yaml_config`	Every stat shifts randomly, slightly positive on average. The range per stat runs from −1 to +1.3 times its step: speed 0.15, damage 0.8, fire delay 0.05 s, shot speed 0.15, range 90, shot size 0.2, luck 2	Treasure, Secret	—	Your stats are now whitespace-sensitive.
	**Extra GPU** `extra_gpu`	Speed +0.1, shot speed +0.1. Outrageously expensive for what it does; that's the joke	Treasure, Shop, Boss	30¢	More FLOPS = More Good!
	**Off-Brand GPU** `offbrand_gpu`	Speed +0.1, shot speed +0.1, but 12 % of your shots are duds: grey, no damage, and they fizzle out after about a third of their range	Treasure, Shop, Boss	20¢	We need more compute, but is this worth it...?

Shot modifiers

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Temperature 1.5** `temperature`	Damage +1.5; shots wobble from side to side	Treasure, Secret	—	More creative. Less correct. Like your commit messages.
	**Few-Shot Examples** `few_shot`	Fires 3 shots in a fan; fire delay ×1.35	Treasure, Boss	—	Three examples. Same mistake, three times.
	**Regex** `regex`	Fires 2 parallel shots. With Few-Shot Examples you get the 3-shot fan instead	Treasure, Shop	15¢	You solved it with a regex. Now you have two shots and two problems.
	**Chain of Thought** `chain_of_thought`	Piercing: shots pass through enemies	Treasure	—	Let's think step by step. Through the enemy. And the one behind it.
	**Confident Hallucination** `confident_hallucination`	Homing shots	Treasure, Secret	—	The target is wherever I say it is.
	**Linter** `linter`	Shots bounce off walls (up to 3 times)	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Your shots bounce now. Also: 4,812 warnings.
	**Dark Mode** `dark_mode`	Spectral: shots fly through rocks and blocks (not walls)	Treasure, Secret	—	Easier on the eyes. Harder on the enemies.
	**Microservices** `microservices`	Shots split into 4 smaller shots (half damage) on impact	Treasure	—	You had one problem. Now it's distributed across four services.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Vibe Coding** `vibe_coding`	Each shot gets random damage ×0.5 to ×2; size and colour vary with it	Treasure, Secret	—	Accept all. Don't read the diff. Feel the vibes.
	**Ctrl+C Ctrl+V** `copy_paste`	Each shot has a 25 % chance to fire a copy at a slight angle	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Why write it twice when you can paste it four times? DRY is a suggestion.
	**Feature Flag** `feature_flag`	In each new room, 50 % chance to be ON: damage +1.5 and fire delay ×0.9 (shots turn green). Always ON right after pickup	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Wrapped in a flag nobody owns. It's on in this room. Probably. Check the shot colour.
	**Benchmark Overfitting** `benchmark_overfitting`	Damage ×0.9, but every hit on a boss deals +60 % bonus damage	Treasure, Boss	—	Scores 98 % on the boss benchmark. Struggles with literally everything else.

Health and protection

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**RLHF** `rlhf`	+1 heart container and a full heal	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Fine-tuned to be more likable. Mostly by people paid per click.
	**Long-Term Support** `long_term_support`	+1 heart container and a full heal, then +1 more container every 2 floors you go down (up to 3 more, so +4 in total)	Treasure, Boss	15¢	Supported for years. Every couple of floors it ships a patch: one more heart, up to three.
	**Swap File** `swap_file`	Hearts you pick up at full health are no longer left on the floor: they go into a swap bar under your hearts (also the unused half of a heart). Every 2 hearts in swap become a new heart container, up to 3	Treasure, Secret	—	When memory is full, write it to disk.
	**Electron App** `electron_app`	+2 heart containers and a full heal; speed −0.15	Treasure, Boss	—	Ships a whole browser. Heavy, but surprisingly hard to kill.
	**Reserved Instances** `reserved_instances`	+2 heart containers and a full heal	Shop only	30¢	Cheaper per hour, as long as you stay. Two more hearts, billed in advance.
	**Graceful Degradation** `graceful_degradation`	+2 heart containers and a full heal; damage −0.2 for every missing full heart (the reverse of git blame)	Treasure, Boss	—	Keeps running when things break. Just worse.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Constitutional Guardrails** `constitutional_guardrails`	+2 guardrail (blue) hearts	Treasure, Shop, Boss	12¢	Principles: has them, mentions them, often.
	**Retry with Backoff** `retry_backoff`	Once per run, survive a lethal hit: come back with half your hearts (at least 1), 2 s invulnerable, enemies frozen for 1.5 s. Costs speed −0.1 for the rest of the run	Treasure, Secret	—	Failed? Try again. Slower.
	**git blame** `git_blame`	Damage +2 while you have 1 heart or less left (red + blue)	Treasure, Secret	—	It was never your fault. The logs prove it.
	**On-Call Pager** `on_call_pager`	When you get hit, enemies within 200 px take 10 damage and are pushed away	Treasure, Secret	—	Woken up at 3 a.m.? Then so is everyone within a 200 px radius.
	**Garbage Collector** `garbage_collector`	Every 12 kills: heal half a heart (or +2¢ at full health) and freeze enemies for 0.6 s	Treasure, Boss	—	Every 12 kills it reclaims half a heart. Stop-the-world pauses included.
	**The Cloud** `the_cloud`	Flight: fly over pits, rocks and spikes	Treasure, Secret	—	It's just someone else's computer. But it floats.

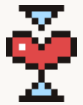
Utility, resources and followers

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Code Review** `code_review`	Shows enemy HP bars; luck +1	Treasure, Shop	10¢	Now you can see exactly how bad things are.
	**Daily Standup** `daily_standup`	Freezes all enemies for 2 s when you enter a room	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Everyone stops what they're doing for "15 minutes".
	**LGTM** `lgtm`	+2 Approvals (keys)	Treasure, Shop	10¢	Didn't read it. Approved it. Twice.
	**Seed Funding** `seed_funding`	+15 credits	Treasure, Boss, Secret	—	Pre-revenue. Pre-product. Pre-everything. Here, have some money.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Rubber Duck** `rubber_duck`	A duck follows you and shoots along with you: ⅓ of your damage, about half your fire rate	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Never says anything. Still the best senior engineer on the team.
	**Unit Tests** `unit_tests`	2 orbiting shields that block enemy shots and deal 2 damage to enemies they touch	Treasure, Shop	15¢	They test nothing, but they're always around you. Coverage: 100 %.

Active items

Use with **Space**. Active items charge by one segment per cleared room and come fully charged when picked up. You can carry one at a time; picking up another swaps them. If there's nothing to do (e.g. full health for /compact), the charge is kept.

	Name	Charge	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Regenerate Response** `regenerate_response`	2	Rerolls every item pedestal in the room (shop prices update), or the pickups if there are no pedestals	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Same prompt. Different answer. Same disappointment.
	**Stop Generating** `stop_generating`	3	Freezes all enemies for 4 s	Treasure, Shop	15¢	■ Stop. Everyone stop. Thank you.
	**rm -rf node_modules** `rm_rf`	4	25 damage to every enemy in the room	Treasure, Shop, Boss	18¢	Freed 4.2 GB. Feels incredible. Nothing builds anymore.
	**/compact** `compact`	6	Heals 2 hearts	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Forget everything except the important bits. You feel lighter.
	**Ctrl+Z** `ctrl_z`	3	Restores your health and guardrails to what they were when you entered the room	Treasure, Shop, Secret	15¢	Restores your health to how it was when you entered the room. Unlike prod.

Pickups

Pickups come from room-clear rewards (35 % chance per cleared room, +3 % per luck), broken rocks (8 %), chests and the shop. Enemies don't drop anything. In addition, 18 % of combat rooms already have 1–2 pickups lying on the floor when you walk in (Credit 67 %, Half Heart 22 %, Approval 11 %). These are the same three kinds the Hallucination disguises itself as, so a pickup in a room that's still fighting may or may not be real. "Drop share" is how often each type is picked when a random drop happens (at luck 0). Luck raises the share of rare drops.

	Name	ID	Effect	Drop share	Shop price
	**Half Heart**	`heart_half`	Heals half a heart (not picked up at full health)	12.5 %	—
	**Heart**	`heart`	Heals 1 heart (not picked up at full health)	8.0 %	3¢
	**Guardrail**	`guardrail`	+1 blue heart (absorbs damage first)	4.5 %	6¢
	**Credit**	`credit`	+1¢	38.6 %	—
	**Credit Stack**	`credit5`	+5¢	4.5 %	—
	**Force Push**	`push`	+1 bomb (`E`): breaks rocks, opens secret rooms, hurts everyone nearby	12.5 %	5¢
	**Double Force Push**	`push2`	+2 bombs	2.3 %	—
	**Approval**	`approval`	+1 key. Opens locked doors (treasure and shop from floor 2) and locked chests. From floor 2, one combat room per floor always drops one	10.2 %	5¢
	**Chest**	`chest`	Opens on touch and scatters a few random pickups	4.5 %	—
	**Locked Chest**	`chest_locked`	Costs 1 Approval. Better loot, and a 15 % chance of an item instead (+2 % per luck, max 40 %)	2.3 %	—
	**README.md**	`readme`	Reveals the map of the current floor, except the secret room. On about half of all floors one lies in a random normal room from the start	never dropped	—

All resources (credits, bombs, keys) are capped at 99. The shop sells 3 of the priced pickups above plus one item.

Room objects

	Name	Where	Effect
	**Pipe**	About 10 % of combat rooms leave one behind when cleared (never in front of a door or in the middle of the room)	Walk in and you're flushed one-way into a random other room of the floor: any room except the boss room, the secret room and the one you're in, visited or not. Reusable, with a new destination each time; after a jump, pipes ignore you for 1 s
	**Trapdoor** (`cd ..`)	Appears in the boss room after the boss dies	Drops you to the next floor

Breakable objects

Normal rooms often contain 1–5 breakable objects. They block movement and shots like rocks, but your shots wear them down (about 2–3 shots at base damage; their HP grows 10 % per floor; spectral shots fly through but still damage them) and any bomb blast destroys them outright. Enemy shots don't damage them, so they also work as cover. Breaking one has a 10 % chance to drop a random pickup. They never block a door or the centre of the room, and they never cut a room in two: you can always walk from every door to every other door without breaking anything.

	Name	`id`	HP (floor 1)	Floors
	**Dusty crate**	`crate`	8	1–2 (Backlog, Legacy Codebase), mixed in on 6, 8, 9, 10
	**Bush**	`bush`	6	3 (Forgotten Branches), mixed in on 7, 8, 10
	**Package**	`package`	8	4–5 (Dependency Hell, Production), mixed in on 7–10
	**Overflowing carton**	`carton`	7	4–5, mixed in on 6, 8, 10

From floor 6 on, the floors mix them more and more: The Training Data has cartons and crates, The Latent Space bushes and packages, and Undefined Behavior and The Context Limit all four.